PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | Azure Security

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience leading incident response and Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations across complex enterprise environments. I have deep hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, and the broader Microsoft security ecosystem, including Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Defender for Cloud Apps. I have managed incidents from P1 to P4 severity, leading investigations across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud environments using structured methodologies aligned with the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 incident response framework and the MITRE ATT&CK framework. My background includes Windows forensics, threat hunting, detection engineering, and security operations at scale, having protected an estate of over 8,000 users at the University of the Arts, London. I am eligible to undergo UK Security Check (SC) clearance vetting.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Incident Response:** P1-P4 severity management, NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, root cause analysis, post-incident reviews
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, detection engineering, workbooks, automation), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, OverWatch), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Azure Cloud Security:** Azure AD, Conditional Access policies, Identity Protection, Microsoft Purview
- **Threat Hunting:** KQL-based proactive hunting in Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel automation rules, Logic Apps, PowerShell scripting
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Windows Forensics:** Log analysis, memory artefacts, endpoint investigation, Tanium
- **Email Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft Defender for Office 365
- **Mobile Device Management:** Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), Conditional Access

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead analyst for P1 and P2 security incidents, coordinating cross-functional response teams and managing the full incident lifecycle from detection through containment, eradication, and recovery in line with NIST 800-61.
- Conduct advanced threat hunting in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, proactively identifying adversary activity across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud environments before automated alerts trigger.
- Engineer and maintain detection rules, analytics, and workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to reduce mean time to detect (MTTD) and improve alert fidelity.
- Lead incident investigation and digital forensics across Windows endpoints, leveraging Defender for Endpoint telemetry, Tanium, and CrowdStrike Falcon to analyse attacker behaviour, reconstruct timelines, and produce post-incident reports.
- Oversee Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Cloud Apps) across the 8,000-user estate, tuning detections and correlating signals for improved coverage.

- Manage identity-related security incidents through Microsoft Entra ID, investigating compromised accounts, reviewing Conditional Access policy efficacy, and enforcing MFA and SSO controls.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to accelerate response to high-frequency alert types, reducing analyst toil by approximately 40%.
- Collaborate with the infrastructure and architecture teams on security requirements for new cloud and hybrid projects, providing assurance against the NIST Cybersecurity Framework and Cyber Essentials Plus.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Triaged and investigated security incidents across the Microsoft 365 and Azure environment, escalating P1 and P2 events and owning P3 and P4 incidents end-to-end.
- Built KQL detection rules and hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel to identify techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, including credential theft, lateral movement, and data exfiltration.
- Led the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 endpoints, establishing baseline policy, onboarding procedures, and alert response playbooks.
- Delivered vulnerability management using Tenable.io and AppCheck, prioritising findings by exploitability and business risk, and tracking remediation to closure.
- Managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access controls and reduce the attack surface associated with privileged accounts.
- Operated CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) for endpoint protection, alert triage, and proactive threat hunting across the estate.
- Supported phishing investigations and email-borne threat analysis using Mimecast, producing detailed incident reports and user awareness guidance.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus assessments and ISO 27001 compliance activities, providing evidence and remediation actions for audit findings.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained security controls across the cloud and on-premise infrastructure, including endpoint protection, identity management, and network security.
- Conducted security assessments and vulnerability scanning, prioritising remediation and reporting findings to senior leadership.
- Managed identity and access controls using Azure Active Directory, including Multi-Factor Authentication rollout and access policy reviews.
- Supported incident response activities, documented procedures, and contributed to business continuity planning.
- Delivered IT infrastructure quality assurance, working across cloud and on-premise environments in a fast-paced SaaS environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 users at UAL, achieving full coverage and measurably improving endpoint detection and response capability.
- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for P1-P2 incidents by engineering automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, cutting manual triage steps by approximately 40%.
- Built a comprehensive threat hunting programme in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, identifying and containing pre-alert adversary activity on multiple occasions.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification across the UAL estate, ensuring adherence to UK government baseline security controls.
- Designed and implemented Conditional Access policies and MFA enforcement in Microsoft Entra ID, significantly reducing the risk of identity-based compromise.
- Conducted Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises using Pentera to validate detection coverage, identifying gaps subsequently addressed through Sentinel detection rule development.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**

- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)